

AIAP - Workbook

Claude Routines: Build a Daily AI News Digest

Demo Video for Reference:  **Claude Routine Workbook.mp4**

What You Will Do

In this workbook, you will build a **Claude Routine** that runs every weekday at 8 AM, reads 5 trusted AI news sources, and emails you a clean digest of what happened in the last 24 hours - delivered to your inbox before your first coffee.

You will plug your **AIAP Day 5 n8n MCP server** into Claude Code so the routine can send real emails (not just drafts). All of this inside Claude Code on the web - no coding required.

What You Will Achieve by the End

- You will have a **live cloud routine** that fires every weekday at 8 AM, even when your laptop is closed.
- You will have **wired your Day 5 n8n MCP** into Claude.ai so the routine can send real emails - not drafts.
- You will have a **reusable prompt pattern** you can adapt for any recurring task - pre-meeting briefs, weekly reports, account watching, and more.

Before You Start: What You Need

Please complete all of the following before starting the activity.

1. A Claude Pro Account

Routines need a Pro subscription. The Free plan does not have access.

- Go to claude.ai - Settings - Plans
- Make sure you are on **Pro (\$20/month)**. If not, upgrade before you continue.

2. Claude Code on the Web

Routines live inside Claude Code. You don't need to write any code.

- Open claude.ai/code in your browser

- Accept any onboarding prompts if it is your first time

3. Your Day 5 n8n MCP Server

This workbook builds on your Day 5 n8n MCP setup.

- Open n8n and confirm your workflow from Day 5 is **Active** (green toggle)
- Have your n8n **Production URL** copied somewhere handy (looks like: `https://your-instance.n8n.cloud/mcp/your-name`)
- If you skipped Day 5, complete that workbook first. This one depends on it! Here: [Day 5 AIAP Workbook](#)

Part 1: Connect Your n8n MCP to Claude.ai

On Day 5, you connected n8n to Claude Desktop using a local config file. For Claude Code routines (which run on the cloud, not your laptop), you need to register the same n8n URL in Claude.ai's connector settings. This is a 2-minute one-time setup.

1.1 Add n8n as a Custom Connector

- Open claude.ai in your browser and sign in.
- Click your profile picture in the top-right → Settings.
- In the left sidebar, click **Connectors**.
- Scroll to **Custom Connectors** and click **Add Custom Connector**.

Add custom connector BETA

Connect Claude to your data and tools. [Learn more about connectors](#) or get started with [pre-built ones](#).

Name

Remote MCP server URL

↑
Advanced settings

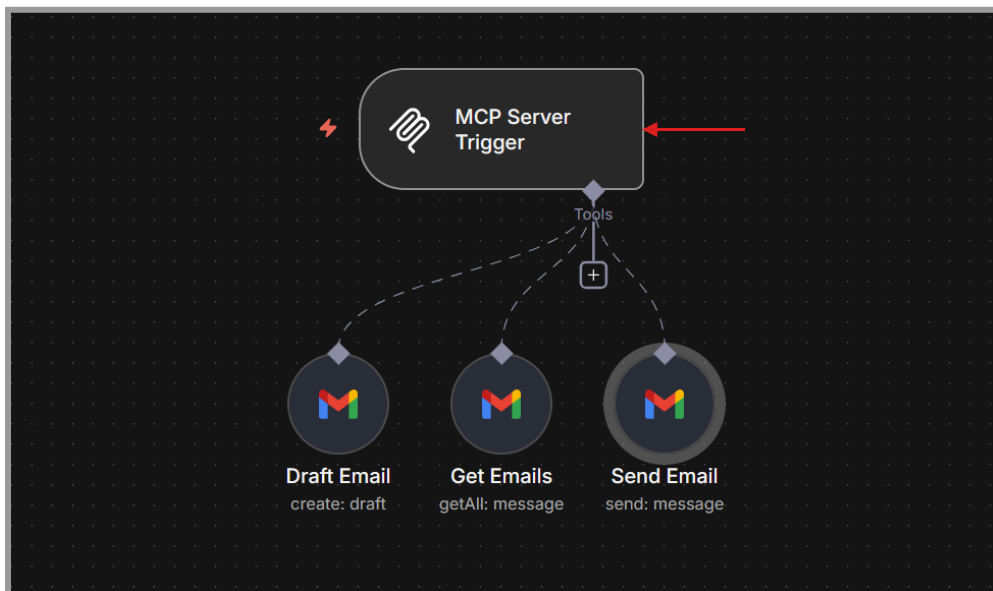
Only use connectors from developers you trust. Anthropic does not control which tools developers make available and cannot verify that they will work as intended or that they won't change.

Building an MCP server? [Report issues and subscribe to updates here](#)

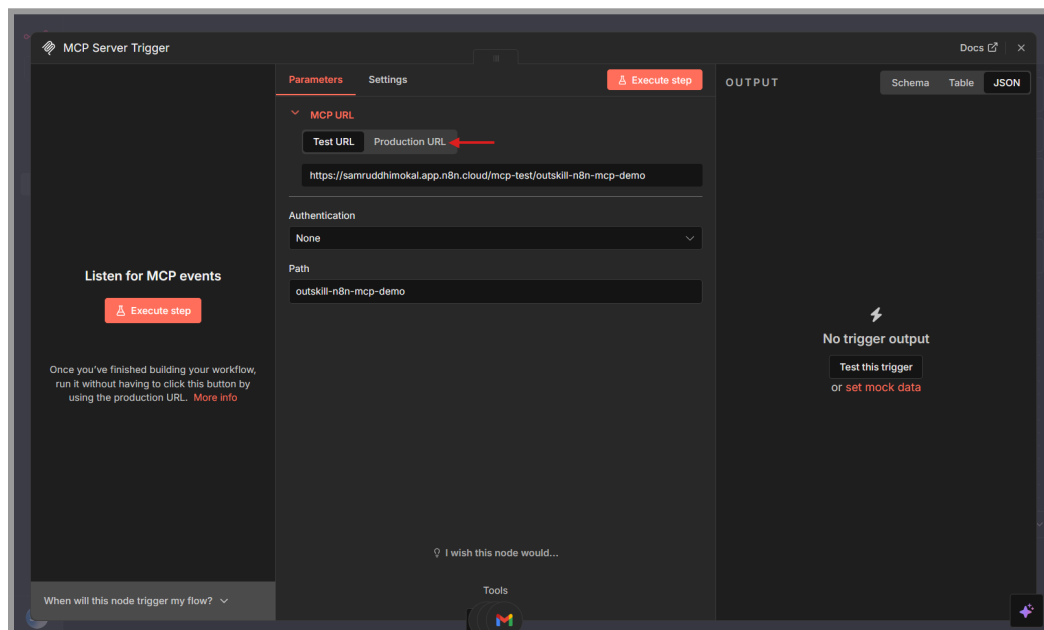
Cancel Add

- In **Name**, type: *Gmail Assistant*

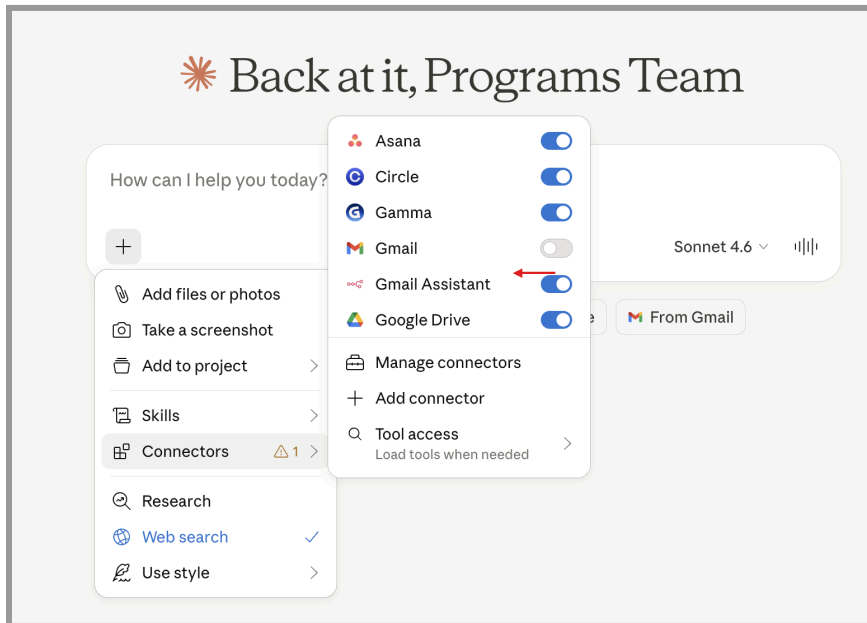
- In **URL**, paste your n8n **Production URL** from Day 5. How to find it: Open your n8n workflow of Day 5.



- Click on **MCP Server Trigger** -> and copy the **Production URL**



- Click **Connect**. The connector should now appear in the list with status **Connected**.

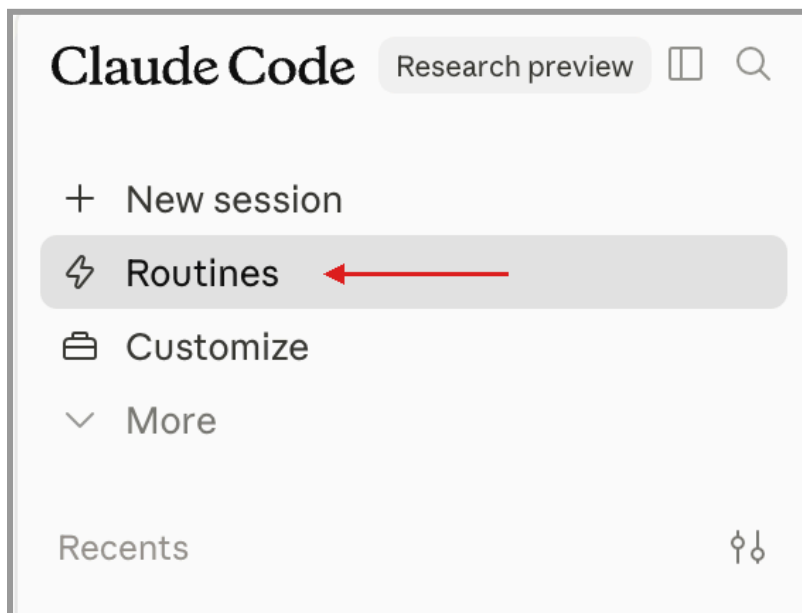


- Your n8n MCP is now wired into Claude.ai. Move on to Part 2.

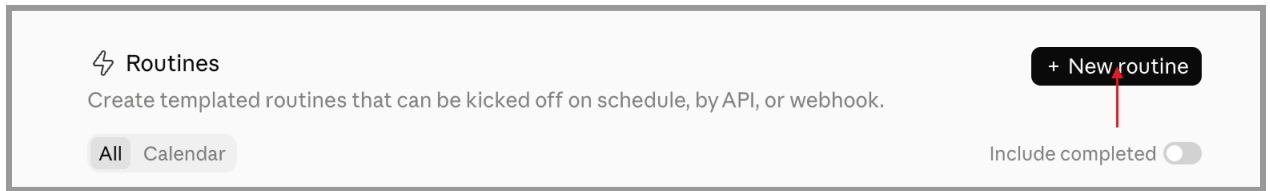
Part 2: The Workflow

Step 2.1 Create a New Cloud Routine

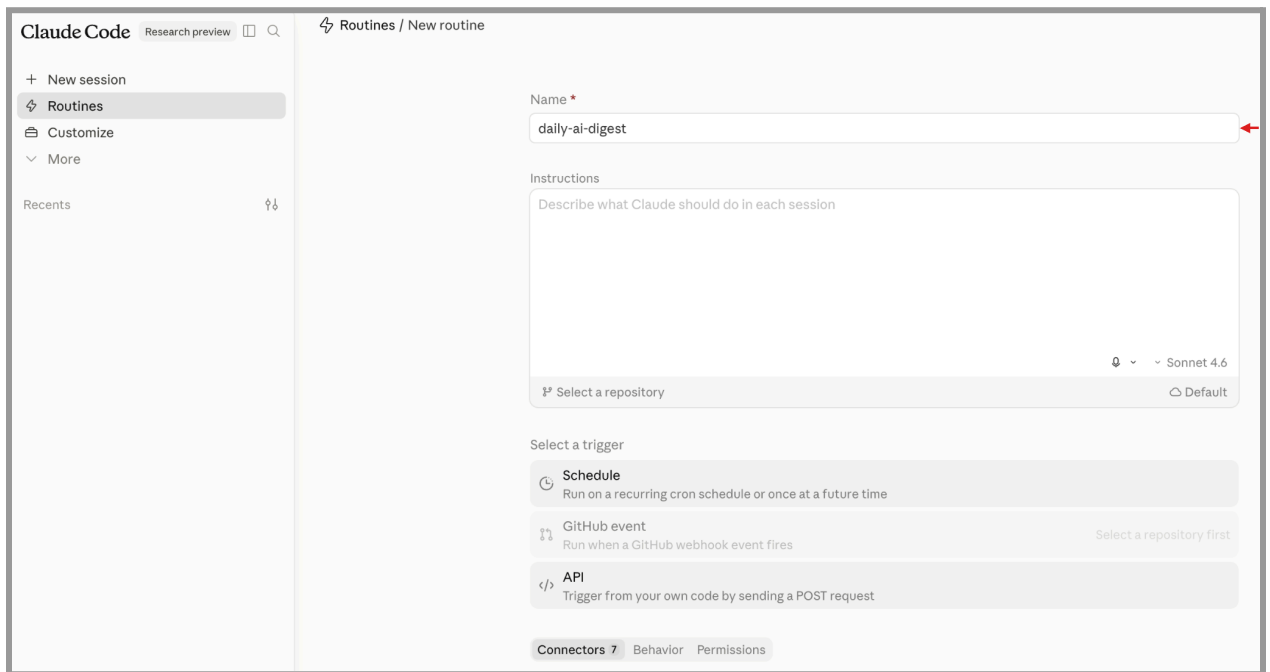
- Go to claude.ai/code in your browser.
- In the left sidebar, click **Routines**.



- In the top right, click + **New Routine**.



- When asked, choose **Remote / Cloud** (so it runs even when your laptop is off).
- In the **Name** field, type: *daily-ai-digest*



Step 2.2 Paste the Prompt

Copy the prompt below and paste it into the Instructions field of your routine.

Prompt: *You are my personal AI news curator. Run this every morning and email me a digest.*

Sources (read articles published in the last 24 hours):

1. <https://www.anthropic.com/news>
2. <https://openai.com/news>
3. <https://the-decoder.com>
4. <https://techcrunch.com/category/artificial-intelligence/>
5. <https://huggingface.co/blog>

Pick the TOP 5-7 stories that match: new model releases, major capability updates, funding above \$50M, new product/API launches, research with practical implications, or policy news affecting AI builders. Skip speculation, rehashes, thinkpieces, and vendor marketing.

Subject line: AI Digest — [today's date in "Mon DD" format]

Email body — write in clean HTML so it renders properly in Gmail:

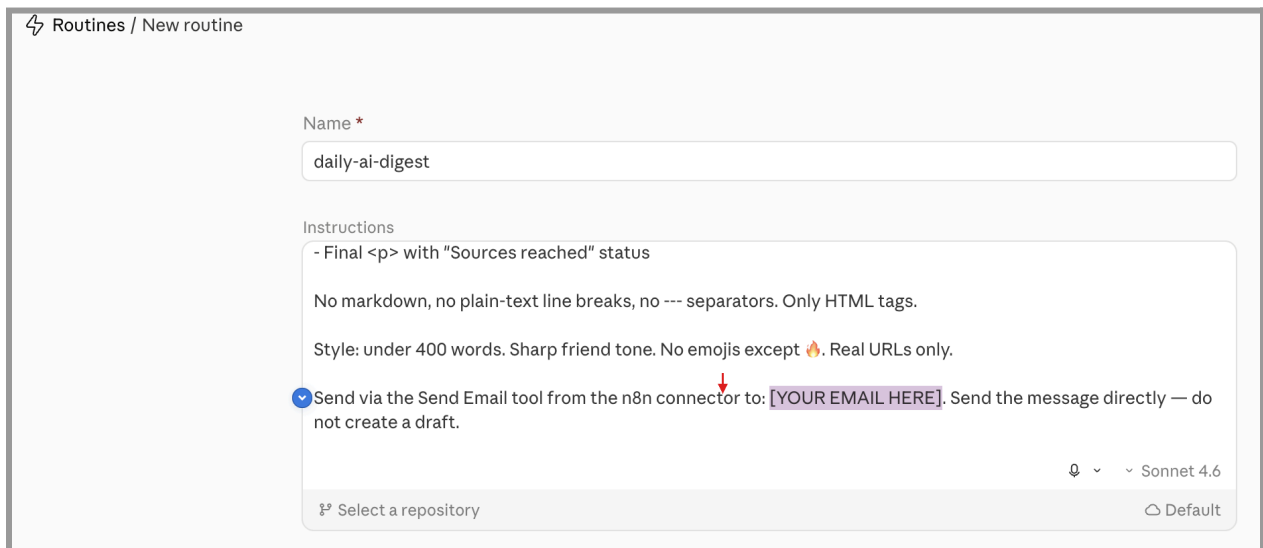
- <p> with a one-line vibe-check of the day
- <h3>🔥 Top story</h3> then <p> containing the headline in , the 2-sentence why-it-matters, and the source link as URL
- <h3>Other notable</h3> then with 4-6 items. Each : headline, the 1-sentence why-it-matters, the tag in [Model | Tool | Research | Funding | Policy], and the link as URL
- Final <p> with "Sources reached" status

No markdown, no plain-text line breaks, no --- separators. Only HTML tags.

Style: under 400 words. Sharp friend tone. No emojis except 🔥. Real URLs only.

Send via the Send Email tool from the n8n connector to: [YOUR EMAIL HERE]. Send the message directly — do not create a draft.

Important: Replace **[YOUR EMAIL HERE]** at the bottom of the prompt with your **actual email address** before saving.



Routines / New routine

Name *

daily-ai-digest

Instructions

- Final <p> with "Sources reached" status

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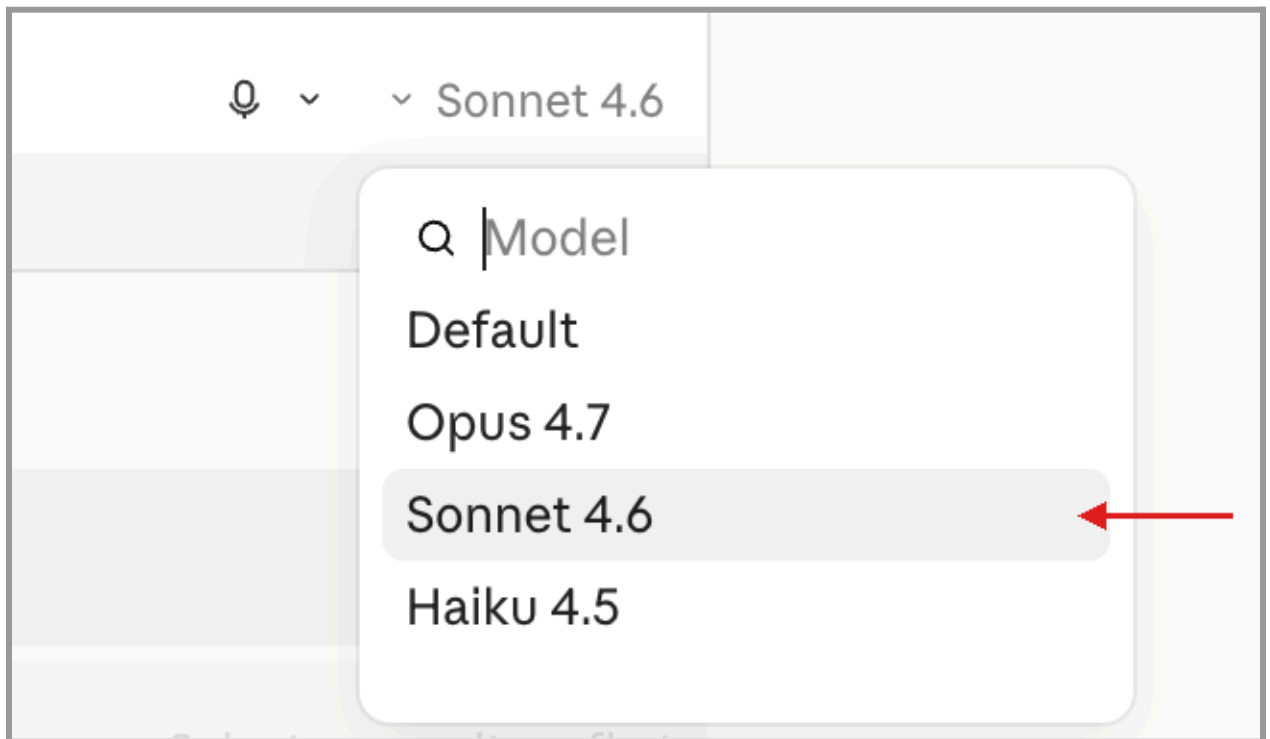
☒ Send via the Send Email tool from the n8n connector to: [YOUR EMAIL HERE]. Send the message directly — do not create a draft.

🔊 Sonnet 4.6

Select a repository Default

Step 2.3 Configure Schedule and Connectors

- Set the model to **Sonnet (latest)**. Avoid Opus for scheduled tasks - costs add up fast.



🔊 Sonnet 4.6

Model

Default

Opus 4.7

Sonnet 4.6

Haiku 4.5

- Set the trigger to **Daily at 8:00 AM** in your local timezone.

Select a trigger

🕒 Runs daily at 8:00 GMT+5:30 ×

Once Hourly **Daily** Weekdays Weekly Custom

At 08:00 AM 🕒

Runs are staggered by a few minutes to spread server load.

- Scroll to **Connectors**. **Enable n8n-gmail** (the one you added in Part 1) and **Disable** the native **Gmail** connector if it's enabled - it can only create drafts, not send. Having both confuses the routine and any other **Connector** you have enabled.

Connectors 1 Behavior Permissions

Connectors

Integrations available to Claude during each run.

🔌 Gmail Assistant × ➕ Add connector

Step 2.4 Save and Run Now

- Click **Create** at the bottom.

🔗 Routines / New routine

Instructions

• Final <p> with "Sources reached" status

No markdown, no plain-text line breaks, no --- separators. Only HTML tags.

Style: under 400 words. Sharp friend tone. No emojis except 🍕. Real URLs only.

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📄 Select a repository Sonnet 4.6 Default

Select a trigger

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Once Hourly **Daily** Weekdays Weekly Custom

At 08:00 AM 🕒

Runs are staggered by a few minutes to spread server load.

+ Add another trigger

Connectors 1 Behavior Permissions

Connectors

Integrations available to Claude during each run.

🔌 Gmail Assistant × ➕ Add connector

⚠️ Claude can use all tools from these connectors — including writes — without asking for permission during runs. Remove any you don't want the agent to access.

Cancel **Create**

- On the routine details page, click **Run now** in the top right.



▶ Run now

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- Final <p> with "Sources reached" status

Runs

No runs yet.

- The routine takes 1 to 3 minutes. Watch the run log on the right - you will see Claude fetching each source and finally calling the n8n Send Email tool.

Step 2.5 Check Your Inbox

- Open the Gmail account you authenticated on Day 5.
- Within a few minutes, you should have an email titled **AI Digest — [today's date]** in your inbox.

- Open it. You should see one TOP STORY (with 🔥), 4-6 OTHER NOTABLE items as a numbered list (each tagged), and a Sources reached note at the bottom.
- **Sample Output:**


to me ▾

OpenAI is shipping hard and Anthropic is going after Wall Street — a busy 24 hours for anyone building on AI.

🔥 Top story

GPT-5.5 Instant is now the default ChatGPT model for all 800M+ weekly active users — OpenAI pushed its newest model to the top of the stack on May 8, reporting a 52.5% reduction in factual errors across high-stakes domains like medicine, law, and finance. If you're benchmarking against "what users actually see," the baseline just moved significantly. <https://the-decoder.com/openai-says-chatgpt-is-growing-again-plans-new-model-this-week/>

Other notable

- 1. OpenAI ships three new production voice API models including GPT-Realtime-2 with GPT-5-class reasoning** — For the first time, live audio gets a truly capable reasoning layer; GPT-Realtime-Translate and GPT-Realtime-Whisper also launch as discrete orchestration primitives, changing what voice agent stacks can actually do. [Model] <https://openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-realtime/>
- 2. Anthropic launches enterprise AI services company with Blackstone, Goldman Sachs, and Hellman & Friedman** — The \$1.5B-committed JV embeds Anthropic engineers and Claude directly into mid-size business operations, a deliberate shot at the traditional consulting model. [Funding] <https://www.anthropic.com/news/enterprise-ai-services-company>
- 3. Anthropic expands Wall Street foothold with AI agents, Moody's data partnership, and full Microsoft 365 integration** — Claude for Word public beta is live as a native tracked-changes sidebar; every AI edit shows up as a reviewable revision, which removes the biggest enterprise adoption friction. [Tool] <https://fortune.com/2026/05/05/anthropic-wall-street-financial-services-agents-jamie-dimon/>
- 4. OpenAI opens self-serve Ad Manager to U.S. advertisers as it targets \$2.5B in ad revenue this year** — ChatGPT is now officially an ad-supported platform; this is worth watching because it changes the incentive structure around which answers ChatGPT surfaces. [Tool] <https://www.axios.com/2026/05/05/openai-self-serve-ad-platform>
- 5. Falcon H1R 7B matches or outperforms reasoning models 2-7x its size** — TII's new open-weight release is worth a benchmark run if you're watching the efficiency frontier; smaller models are getting dangerously close to closed-model quality at a fraction of the cost. [Model] <https://huggingface.co/blog/tiuae/falcon-h1r-7b>

Sources reached: Anthropic News, OpenAI News, The Decoder, Fortune, Axios, Hugging Face Blog.

You're Done!

Here is what you just accomplished:

- You wired your Day 5 n8n MCP into Claude.ai's connector ecosystem.
- You created a cloud routine that runs on Anthropic's servers - not your laptop.
- You set up a 5-source AI news digest that delivers a real email to your inbox every weekday at 8 AM.

Tomorrow morning at 8 AM, this runs again. And the morning after. Without you doing anything.

Quick Tips

- **No email arrived?** Check your spam folder first. Mark as *Not spam* once and Gmail will learn.

- **Run failed with "no email tool"?** You forgot to enable n8n-gmail in Step 2.3. Edit the routine, enable it, save, run again.
- **Run completed but no email sent?** Open your n8n workflow and make sure it's still toggled **Active**. Inactive workflows can't receive MCP requests.
- **Want a different time or source?** Edit the routine, change the time or swap source URLs in the prompt, save.
- **Email has "Sent automatically with n8n" footer?** In n8n, open your **Send Email** tool - **Options** - turn off "Append n8n attribution". Save the workflow. The next run will be clean.
- **Email looks like a wall of text?** Make sure the prompt's email format section says *write in clean HTML*. Without HTML tags, n8n collapses everything into one paragraph.

More Use Cases to Try

The same pattern - Claude Routine + n8n MCP - works for any recurring task. Once your AI digest is running, try one of these:

- **Pre-Meeting Brief** - reads today's calendar, researches each attendee, emails you a one-pager per meeting at 8 AM.
- **Inbox Triage** - categorises overnight emails, drafts replies for routine ones, surfaces only what needs your brain.
- **Friday Wrap & Monday Plan** - reads your calendar and sent folder, drafts a weekly recap and Monday's top-3 priorities every Friday at 5 PM.
- **Account Watcher** - monitors 10-20 named accounts weekly for exec changes, funding, and product launches.

For each, the routine setup is identical - only the prompt and the n8n tools you wire up change.